

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Art
Iowa State University College of Design

Catalog: 2025 - present

128 Credits Required

University Requirement May be standalone courses or included within completion other courses	6 total credits
International Perspectives	3 credits
US Cultures and Communities	3 credits

Communications	10
ENGL 150 (C or better) Critical Thinking and Communication	3
ENGL 250 (C or better) Written, Oral, Visual and Electronic Composition	3
Select 1 course from COMST 1010, 1020, SPCM 1100, 2120	3
LIB 160 Introduction to College Level Research	1

Humanities*	6
	3
	3

Social Sciences*	6
	3
	3

Math, Physical Sciences, and Biological Sciences*	6
	3
	3

Additional General Education Courses*	9
3000-4000 level	3
3000-4000 level	3
Any level	3

College of Design Core	13
DSNS 1830 Design in Context	3
DSNS 1020 Design Studio I	4
DSNS 1310 Drawing I	4
DSNS 1150 Design Seminar	1
DSNS 1320 Digital Design Literacy	1

* For a complete list of approved courses for Humanities, Social Sciences, and Math/Science, consult the Iowa State University College of Liberal Arts and Sciences General Education Approved Course List

Courses within the College of Design (ARTGR, ARCH, ARTH, CRP, DSNS, DES, INDD, ARTID) do not fulfill general education requirements for art majors.

Integrated Studio Arts Core	31
ART 2020 Wood	2
ART 2030 Jewelry/Metalsmithing	2
ART 2040 Ceramics	2
ART 2060 Printmaking	2
ART 2080 Color	2
ART 2100 Photography	2
ART 2130 Painting	2
ART 2140 Textiles	2
ART 2300 Drawing II	3
ART 2120 Computers	3
ART 3100 Sources and Methods of Visual Art	3
ART H 2800 History of Art I	3
ART H 2810 History of Art II	3

Art & Design History	9
3000-4000 level ARTH	3
3000-4000 level ARTH	3
3000-4000 level ARTH	3

ISA Concentration (upper level studios)	24
	3
	3
	3
	3
	3
	3
	3

Professional Practice	3
ART 3990 Professional Practice	2
ART 4990 BFA Exhibition	1

Electives- take as needed to reach 128 credit minimum	11
DSNS 3010 Rome Pre-departure	1
ART 2990x – Learning Community	1

Year 2

All 2-credit ART studios are half-semester courses. It is highly recommended that students choose 'paired' studios for ease of scheduling. Below are two examples. Course times and pairings subject to change, please refer to the university class schedule for the current semester's 'pairs.'

Student 1's Semester Art	Student 2's Semester Art
- TR morning: Painting, then Color in the second half of the semester - TR afternoon: Photo, then Printmaking 3-credit studio MW morning: Drawing II	- MW morning: Woods, then Textiles in the second half of the semester - MW afternoon: Ceramics, then Metals 3-credit studio TR afternoon: Digital Media

Rome Option

Students may participate in the College of Design Rome Program in the fall of their third or fourth year.

ART Studio Option, 3 credits
 ART Studio Option, 3 credits
 ART Studio Option, 3 credits
 ARTH 3000+ level (required), 3 credits
 DSNS 4920 (required, elective, 1 credit)

Students choosing this option should plan to take an general education class and an elective in another semester because these courses are not offered in Rome. If necessary, additional course(s) may be added to a semester in Rome. See your academic advisor for details.

Suggested Sequence

Year 1	Fall Semester		Spring Semester	
	DSNS 1020 or DSNS 1310	4	DSNS 1020 or DSNS 1310	4
	DSNS 1830 or General Education	3	DSNS 1830 or General Education	3
	ENGL 1500 or General Education	3	ENGL 1500 or General Education	3
	DSNS 1100 or DSNS 1150	1	General Education: math/science	3
	General Education: math/science	3	General Education: social sci./hum.	3
	General Education: social sci./hum.	3	Library 1600	1
	<i>DSNS 1320 if taking 1020</i>	1	<i>DSNS 1320 if taking 1020</i>	1
		17-18		17-18
Year 2				
	ART 2020-2140 Studio Fundamentals	2	ART 2020-2140 Studio Fundamentals	2
	ART 2020-2140 Studio Fundamentals	2	ART 2020-2140 Studio Fundamentals	2
	ART 2020-2140 Studio Fundamentals	2	ART 2020-2140 Studio Fundamentals	2
	ART 2020-2140 Studio Fundamentals	2	ART 2020-2140 Studio Fundamentals	2
	ART 2300 or ART 2120	3	ART 2300 or ART 2120	3
	ARTH 2800	3	ARTH 2810	3
	ENGL 2500 or General Education	3	ENGL 2500 or General Education	3
	ART 2990x – Learning Community	1		
		18		17
Year 3	<i>(or, complete Rome Option)</i>			
	ART 3100 or elective	3	ART 3100 or elective	3
	ART Studio Option	3	ART Studio Option	3
	ART Studio Option	3	ART Studio Option	3
	ARTH 3000+ level	3	ARTH 3000+ level	3
	General Education	3	ART 3990 Professional Practice I	2
		15	<i>DSNS 3010 Study Abroad Preparation</i>	1
				14-15
Year 4	<i>(or, complete Rome Option)</i>			
	ART Studio Option	3	ART Studio Option	3
	ART Studio Option	3	ART Studio Option	3
	ARTH 3000+ Level	3	General Education	3
	Additional studio, gen ed, or elective	3	ART 4990	1
	Additional studio, gen ed, or elective	3	Elective	3
		15	Elective	2
				15